

Assignment No. 8

Setup Guide: PHP · Composer · Laravel · Node.js · php.ini Configuration

01. PHP — PATH Configuration

- 1 Launch **Command Prompt** and type `php -v` to see if PHP is already set up.
- 2 If no version shows, browse to your **XAMPP** folder and open the *php* directory.
- 3 Copy the directory path from the File Explorer address bar.
- 4 Access **Environment Variables** via System Properties → Advanced tab.
- 5 Under *System Variables*, press **New**, paste in the path, and confirm with **OK**.
- 6 Open a fresh Command Prompt and run `php -v` — the PHP version should now display.
- 7 If it still doesn't work, verify the path and redo steps 4 to 6.

02. Composer — Dependency Manager

- 1 Search **Composer PHP** online and visit the official getcomposer.org website.
- 2 Navigate to **Download** and get the Windows installer.
- 3 Open the installer and grant any requested permissions.
- 4 Follow the setup steps with **Next** and end with **Finish**.
- 5 Test by running `composer -v` in Command Prompt.
- 6 If the command isn't recognised, rerun the installer from the beginning.

03. Laravel — Framework Setup

- 1 Go to the **Laravel official site** and open the installation documentation.
- 2 Copy the command shown: `composer global require laravel/installer`.
- 3 Run it in Command Prompt and wait for installation to finish.
- 4 Make a new folder called **my_app** somewhere convenient (e.g. Desktop).
- 5 Open Command Prompt *inside* that folder by typing `cmd` in the Explorer address bar.
- 6 Run `laravel new my_app` to initialise the project.

04. Node.js — JavaScript Runtime

- 1 Head to **nodejs.org** and grab the LTS release for your OS.
- 2 Open the installer file and accept permission/licence prompts.
- 3 Proceed through the installer with **Next** and click **Finish**.
- 4 In Command Prompt, run `node -v` and `npm -v` to validate the install.
- 5 Missing output? Uninstall, re-download, and reinstall Node.js.

05. php.ini — Activating the ZIP Extension

- 1 Open the **php.ini** file in VS Code from your *XAMPP/php* directory.
- 2 Use **Ctrl + F** to search for `extension=zip` (roughly line 962).
- 3 Remove the semicolon at the start of that line to uncomment it.
- 4 Save, then run `php -m` in Command Prompt.
- 5 Confirm *zip* appears in the list. If absent, make sure you have PHP **8.2**.

! *PHP 8.0 does not include this extension declaration. You must be on version 8.2.*

06. New Project — Scaffold & Run

- 1 Open Command Prompt inside **XAMPP/htdocs**.
- 2 Execute `laravel new my_app` and respond to each prompt:
- 3 Starter kit → **None**
- 4 Testing framework → **0**
- 5 AI coding assistant → **No**
- 6 Database → **MySQL**
- 7 Run default migrations → **Yes**
- 8 Skip npm install → **Yes**
- 9 Change into the project folder with `cd my_app` and then run `composer run dev`.
- 1 Load `localhost:8000` in a browser to confirm the project is running.
- 0

! *Already have a project? Navigate to `htdocs/project-folder` in `cmd` and run `'composer run dev'`.*